



Fig. 2: Google is flying Internet balloons (Courtesy: Google)

The Internet hurries to Harisal

Harisal is a medium-size village in Maharashtra that was recently earmarked for a major digital transformation. Maharashtra government together with Microsoft hopes to connect the village and make it smart, with facilities ranging from telemedicine and cashless markets to banking and education. While all this sounds too good to be true and some educated villagers are quite excited about getting jobs through this digitisation, news reports show that most villagers are not very hopeful.

The region faces severe load-shedding and power voltage is so low that bulbs barely light up a small room. Apparently, villagers are sometimes even reprimanded for running motors to pump water or watching television at home. Government officials, however, claim that this is likely to change as they have plans for more electricity from a nearby grid and also from renewable sources. Speaking to *NDTV* in November, the officials stated that BSNL had finished laying fibre-optic cables, and Indus would erect a mobile tower right outside the *panchayat* office. Although there might be issues along the way, they are confident that everything will be ironed out and villagers are sure to benefit from the connectivity.

This is a typical example of the situation in most Indian villages. Even when technology is on its way to their homes, they still face innumerable other troubles, which make the benefits hard to reap. What we need is a concerted effort by various departments, ranging from electricity to telecommunications, with a lot of help from technology companies and cooperation of the villagers, to make India truly digital. However, at *EFY*, we are confident that Indians can do it, and hope to see some of the pieces fit in place this year.

circuit boards to control the system, and radio antennae to communicate with other balloons and with Internet antennae on the ground. There are also lithium-ion batteries to store solar power, generated by an array of solar panels, mounted on a light aluminium frame, which flies with the balloon. With all this, the balloons provide Long-Term Evolution (LTE) based connectivity to a ground area of 80km diameter, by sharing the mobile spectrum with

telecommunications companies.

People can connect to the balloon network directly from their phones and other LTE-enabled devices. The signal is then passed across the balloon network and back down to the global Internet on the Earth. This ability to use standard mobile devices to connect is what makes Project Loon appear more attractive than satellite or white space based systems that require special devices.

Loon has been tested suc-

DIGITAL CLAMP METERS

36-AUTO

27-AUTO

36-AUTO (AC/DC)

- 3½ Digit 4000 Counts
- Auto Ranging
- Current Upto 600A AC/DC
- Voltage Upto 600V AC/DC
- Resistance Upto 40MΩ
- Jaw Opening Upto 25mm
- Auto Power Off
- Non Contact Voltage
- Temp., Capacitance, Data Hold, Hz/Duty, REL (Zero)

27-AUTO (AC)

- 3½ Digit, 2000 Counts
- Auto Ranging
- Current Upto 400A AC
- Voltage Upto 600V AC/DC
- Resistance Upto 20MΩ
- Jaw Opening Upto 25mm
- Auto Power Off
- Non Contact Voltage
- Data Hold & Max Function

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